ITINERARY REVIEW · SAMPLE

Kyoto → Shirakawa-go → Takayama

A 2-day plan made with an AI tool, reviewed day by day with Japanese sources.

WHEN	TRAVELERS	GETTING AROUND	STAYING
2 days in January	**2 adults**	**Train + bus**	**Takayama (booked)**

2 keep	4 change	3 add
Works as planned	Would fail or waste time	Local picks for your style

What I found

	Your AI plan said	What I found and what to do
CHANGE	*Day 1: Fushimi Inari 9:00–11:00, then Shirakawa-go by 1 pm*	Kyoto to Shirakawa-go takes about 4 hours including transfers (train via Tsuruga and Kanazawa, then a highway bus). Leaving Kyoto after 11:00, you arrive mid-to-late afternoon, with sunset around 5 pm in January. **Visit Fushimi Inari at 7:00 instead**: it is open all night and almost empty at first light. Source: JR West timetable; Hokutetsu / Nohi Bus timetable
CHANGE	*"Buy bus tickets at the station"*	Many Kanazawa–Shirakawa-go departures need a reservation, and seats go fast in winter. **Book online as soon as your date is set.** Source: Hokutetsu / Nohi Bus reservation pages (Japanese)
CHANGE	*Shirakawa-go → Takayama "any bus, about 50 min"*	About 50 minutes is right, but some departures on this route require a reservation, and winter has fewer runs. **Reserve the late-afternoon bus** so you are not left waiting in the snow. Source: Nohi Bus timetable (R marks)
CHANGE	*Dinner at a well-known Hida beef restaurant from your plan*	Popular in English reviews, but mixed reviews on Japanese sites, with comments about price and long waits. **A smaller grill a short walk away** is rated higher by Japanese diners. Source: Japanese review sites (names given in your full plan)
KEEP	*Day 2: Miyagawa morning market*	Good choice. In winter it opens at 8 am and winds down around noon, so go first thing.
KEEP	*Takayama Jinya, Hida Folk Village, train back to Kyoto*	Open on your dates; the order and travel times work.
ADD	—	**Shiroyama viewpoint** for the classic Shirakawa-go view: go straight there on arrival, before the tour groups.
ADD	—	**Hida-Furukawa**, a quiet canal town 15–25 minutes from Takayama by train, if you want a slower morning on Day 2.

Also in the full review: one more local pick, and a booking list with deadlines (see page 2).

YOUR UPDATED DAY 1

Kyoto → Shirakawa-go → Takayama

Times below are rounded for this sample. In your plan, every train and bus time is checked against the official timetable for your date.

7:00 **Fushimi Inari Taisha** MOVED EARLIER
Quiet gates at first light. In 1 hour you can walk the Senbon Torii and back.

8:30 **Kyoto Station → Tsuruga** (limited express Thunderbird)
About 50 minutes. Reserved seat recommended.

9:30 **Tsuruga → Kanazawa** (Hokuriku Shinkansen)
About 50 minutes. The Shinkansen is on a different level from the limited express: allow 10–15 minutes.

11:10 **Kanazawa → Shirakawa-go** (highway bus) BOOK AHEAD
About 1 hour 25 minutes. Many departures need a reservation. Grab lunch to go at Kanazawa Station.

12:40 **Shiroyama viewpoint** LOCAL PICK
Shuttle from near Wada House, or a 15–20 minute walk uphill. Paths can be icy: bring shoes with grip.

13:40 **Village walk and Wada House**
Wada House is open 9:00–17:00. Many cafés close by 4 pm in winter.

16:00 **Shirakawa-go → Takayama** (Nohi Bus) RESERVE
About 50–60 minutes. A good late-afternoon option; later buses also run.

17:30 **Dinner in Takayama** BETTER OPTION
The smaller grill from page 1. Arrive before 6 pm to avoid the wait.

Booking list

What	When to book	Note
Kanazawa → Shirakawa-go bus	As soon as your date is set	Winter seats sell out
Shirakawa-go → Takayama bus	Same time as above	Some departures need a reservation
Thunderbird + Shinkansen seats	From 1 month before, 10:00	Covered by the JR Pass; reserve seats anyway

Light-up nights in Shirakawa-go (a few dates in January and February) require advance booking. If your date falls on one, I flag it and adjust the plan.